Lesson 5.1: Non-destructive editing, frequency separation and compositing

What you learn

- **Non-destructive.** Use layers, adjustment layers, masks and smart objects so edits can be changed.
- **Frequency separation.** Splits colour and tone from fine texture so skin can be smoothed while keeping natural texture. Keep retouching subtle and honest.
- **Compositing.** Match light direction, colour and perspective.
- **Colour correction.** Set a neutral white point first.

Tools and resources (official sites, not checked live)

- Photoshop tutorials

ASSIGNMENT

Practice for lesson 5.1

Business problem: Retouch a portrait.

Steps

1. Work on layers only.
2. Remove blemishes with frequency separation.
3. Compare before and after.

Expected output: A natural result with all edits on separate layers.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

If you can hide a layer and the original returns, the edit is non-destructive.

Check yourself

1. Why use adjustment layers?
   Answer: They can be changed later.
2. Why keep retouching subtle?
   Answer: It looks natural and honest.

Lesson 5.1 of the **Design and Creative** lessons. See this lesson and its official links on skillnavora.in · All chapters and lessons · Open the full lesson guide. Tools, prices and plans change; confirm on each official site.